

BBQ THE HOUSE



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Q & A

EVERY CHABAD HOUSE is a replica of Avraham Avinu's tent. Avraham and Sarah provided passersby with food, while at the same time teaching them about Hashem and that it is He who must be thanked for the food. Similarly, as we serve gefilte fish and cholent, we teach our guests what it means to be a Jew and serve Hashem.¹

This article addresses some of the common questions that may arise when inviting guests for a Shabbos meal, along with some other questions pertaining to Shabbos in the Chabad House.

It is important to note that the goal of this article is to provide general guidelines. It is not intended to provide a comprehensive treatment of the topics discussed, and many scenarios and details were not touched upon. Whenever you have a specific question, a rov should be consulted.

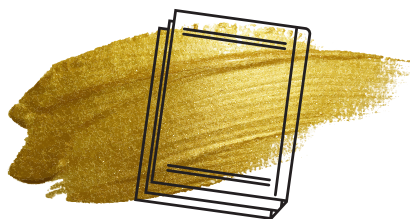
Note: A number of previous halachah articles covered Shabbos-related questions.

For questions about toys and games on Shabbos, and other children-related issues, see Compass Magazine, vol. 24, pp. 34–45.

For questions about preparing on Shabbos for motzoei Shabbos or on the first day of yom tov for the second, see Compass Magazine, vol. 24, pp. 37–38.

For questions relating to amirah l'akum, see Compass Magazine, vol. 5, pp. 7–10; vol. 24, pp. 43–44.

If you have any other halachic questions or topics you would like to see addressed in future editions of Compass Magazine, please email editor@compass-magazine.org.



SHABBOS INVITATIONS

Q: MAY I INVITE PEOPLE FOR A SHABBOS MEAL OR MINYAN IF THEY DO NOT LIVE WITHIN WALKING DISTANCE?²

A: If you are arranging a peulah (e.g., a minyan, High Holiday services, Pesach seder), you may notify people about it, even if some of them do not live within walking distance. Similarly, if someone asks you for information about the event, you may tell them about it without first asking them where they live. This is because you are not inviting them personally; you are simply letting them know what will be taking place.

When giving a personal invitation for a Friday night meal, the guests should be told to come before Shabbos. (An added benefit is that female guests will be able to light Shabbos candles.) To avoid the problem of causing them to drive back, they

should be told that you have a room where they can sleep and they are welcome to spend the night with you. That way, even if they decide to leave, it is not you who is causing them to do a melachah.³

Similarly, when inviting guests personally for the Shabbos day meal, they should be told that the Chabad House is open and they are welcome to come on Friday and spend Shabbos there. Even if they decline the offer, the fact that they end up driving is not your doing. This is also what should be done if asking specific people to come for the minyan on Shabbos.

What if offering such an invitation is not an option (e.g., you are inviting a large number of guests and there is no way to theoretically accommodate all of them)?

One rationale is that if they would not come to you, in all probability they would drive somewhere else instead. Now they will come to a Shabbos meal instead of going to the movies. A rov should be consulted to determine whether this leniency can be relied upon.

If the Chabad House has a private parking lot, it should be closed on Shabbos. This gives the clear message that the shliach does not sanction driving to shul on Shabbos, and that those who do drive are doing so on their own initiative.

(See sidebar on p. 29 for how the Rebbe reacted to people who drove on Shabbos.)

² For a lengthy discussion on this topic, see *Nesivim Bisdei Hashlichus*, vol. 1, pp. 199–224; *Shalos Uteshuvs Hashluchim*, pp. 142–161.

³ This was the guidance given by Reb Zalman Shimon Dworkin AH (see *Shlichus Kehilchah*, p. 89).

¹ See *Sefer Hasichos* 5749 (vol. 1, pp. 50ff and fn. 27).



Q: MAY I INVITE A NON-JEW TO A SHABBOS OR YOM TOV MEAL (E.G., AN INTERMARRIED COUPLE)?

A: A non-Jew may be invited for a Shabbos meal,⁴ but not for a yom tov meal (unless it is also Shabbos). The reason is that Chazal were concerned that the host might cook extra food for the non-Jew on yom tov, which is forbidden.⁵ However, if a non-Jew came on his own accord (e.g., you invited a Jew and he brought along a non-Jewish friend), he may join the meal.⁶

It is permitted to set up an online form where guests can register to join a yom tov meal (even if some non-Jews will sign up as well).

Q: MAY I ACCEPT A GIFT THAT WAS BROUGHT BY A GUEST ON SHABBOS OR YOM TOV?

A: Many shaylos can arise when guests bring gifts. If bringing the gift to the house involved a melachah (e.g., on Shabbos if there is no eiruv, or on yom tov if the guest drove), it is problematic to accept it. Even during the week, gifts are accompanied by numerous shaylos: a guest might bring a food item of questionable kashrus, non-mevushal wine, chometz on Pesach, and the like.

In order to avoid shaylos, it is recommended to adopt a no-gift policy (in which you request that guests not bring

⁴ Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch 325:1.

⁵ Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch 512:1.

⁶ Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch 512:2.

Maaseh Rav WHEN A JEW DROVE TO 770 ON SHABBOS

"MAH SHEHU OSEH, omer l'yisroel laasos." There were times when Jews drove to 770 on Shabbos and yom tov. The Rebbe's methodology in handling these situations is very telling.

One year in the 5700s, on the second day of Sukkos, a non-shomer-Shabbos Jew participated in the meal in the Frierdiker Rebbe's sukkah. Only one bottle of wine was brought to the sukkah, and it was completely covered with a towel. The Rebbe (the "Ramash") kept the bottle under the table near his seat, and the Rebbe poured wine from the bottle for each person to say l'chaim.

After the meal, the Rebbe turned to this person and said (in English), "No hard feelings!" (Apparently, the Rebbe said this in reference to the changes in the meal that were implemented due to this Jew's presence.) The guest responded (in Yiddish), "I am a chossid! I understand!"

The Rebbe then told the guest that the chassidim would now be reviewing the Frierdiker Rebbe's sichos in the small zal, and he invited him to participate. Together, they made their way to the zal and listened to chazarah. Chazarah was followed by Maariv, after which the Rebbe wished him "A freilechen Chol Hamoed" and the Jew drove home.

What is striking about this story is that the Rebbe generally did not participate in chazarah, and he deviated from his regular custom to prevent a Jew from being mechalel Shabbos.¹

Another incident:

A certain non-observant Jew who avidly loved the Frierdiker Rebbe would often drive to 770 on Shabbos to participate in the farbrengen. He continued doing so after the Rebbe accepted the nesius.

One Sukkos, during the farbrengen, the Rebbe spoke to this Jew fervently about the importance of keeping Shabbos. The Jew was overcome with emotion, and, in the middle of the conversation, took out his car keys and placed them before the Rebbe. "Rebbe!" he exclaimed, "Here are my keys! Take them!"

The Rebbe took the keys,² accepting "ownership" of the car. He then returned them, saying, "I am giving the keys back to you under the following condition: I allow you to use the car—which is now mine—throughout the week, but on Shabbos you may not drive it."³

¹ Teshurah (Goldman-Teitelbaum, 9 Elul 5776), p. 17, as related by Rabbi Moshe Pesach Goldman.

² If this detail of the story is accurate, perhaps the ring with the car key held other keys as well, so there was no issue of muktzeh involved.

³ Cited in *Shaalos Uteshuvos Hashluchim*, pp. 158–159 in the name of Reb Yoel Kahan.



any gifts at all), or to give specific guidelines as to which gifts can be brought and when (e.g., whole fresh fruit or flowers before 3:00 p.m. on Friday). This will also avoid embarrassing situations (where the shliach is forced to throw out the gift, etc.).

If a guest brings an unsolicited gift and doing so involved a melachah, it is questionable as to whether it may be used or consumed on Shabbos or yom tov (even if it has no kashrus issues and the like),⁷ and each shliach should consult his rov. If the item was brought from outside the techum on Shabbos or yom tov, it may certainly not be used until motzoei Shabbos or motzoei yom tov.⁸ In any case, there is a practical reason to refrain from using the gift. Using it will set a precedent, and the guests might feel that they should continue bringing gifts in the future. When they see that you are not using it, they will realize that you are serious about your policy.

Whenever a package is delivered on Shabbos, we are particular not to accept it until the item has been put down, or at least until the delivery man has stopped walking.⁹ The same guidelines should be followed if a guest brings a gift.

Care must also be taken not to transgress the issur of muktzeh where applicable, as well as the issurim that might apply when opening packages. (Details relating to opening packages on Shabbos and yom tov will appear in a future issue, b'ezras Hashem.)

If a guest brings chometz on Chol Hamoed Pesach, it must be destroyed immediately. If it is Shabbos or yom tov, you must tell the guest to put the gift in a corner, and it must be covered until the next possible time it can be destroyed.¹⁰

If a guest brings a potted plant on Shabbos or yom tov, it may not be handled due to the issur of muktzeh. A bouquet of flowers is not muktzeh, but it may not be placed in water.¹¹

7 See *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 454:12; *Ketzos Hashulchan*, 124 fn. 5.

8 For the details of this halachah, see *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 515:11–17.

9 See *Shemiras Shabbos Kehilchasah* (third edition) 31:22; *ibid.*, ch. 30, fn. 60.

10 See *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 446.

11 See *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 336:18.

Again, the best approach is to adopt a no-gift policy or to set specific guidelines, as mentioned above.

Q: WHAT IS CHABAD'S STANCE ON ACCEPTING SHABBOS EARLY WITH A MINYAN (E.G., IN THE SUMMER MONTHS)?

A: Halachically, a minyan may accept Shabbos and daven Maariv early, as long as it is after plag haminchah. However, if doing so, those who will be davening in that minyan should daven Minchah before plag haminchah¹² and remember to say Krias Shema again after tzeis hakochavim.¹³

There is no clear-cut minhag in Chabad on this matter. However, it is known that the Rebbe never accepted Shabbos early, and indeed many in Chabad make a point of not doing so either.¹⁴

(A related anecdote: Before one of the summer pegishos in Crown Heights, an idea was raised to start Shabbos early, so that there would be time for a program for the guests on Friday night. When the organizers sent the schedule to the Rebbe, the Rebbe replied, "Here [in Crown Heights] no one accepts Shabbos early."¹⁵ In other words, the Rebbe was telling them not to adopt a practice that was not done in the local community.¹⁶)

12 Some say you are allowed to daven both Minchah and Maariv after plag haminchah and before nightfall, if both tefillos are being davened with a minyan and it will be difficult to gather the minyan again once it has dispersed (*Mishnah Berurah* 233:11). However, the Alter Rebbe does not mention this distinction (*Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 267:2).

13 *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 267:2.

14 See *Shu"t Admor Hazaken* (end of §7) that it is customary not to daven Maariv before nightfall.

A related point: If you never daven Maariv before nightfall and you walk into a shul where they are davening Maariv early, you may keep your custom and wait until nightfall before davening, even though you will miss davening with a minyan (*Tzemach Tzedek, Chiddushim al Hashas* 1d).

15 As heard from Rabbi Kasriel Kastel. This is the gist of the Rebbe's reply; the exact wording is unknown.

16 There is another concern as well: After having accepted Shabbos, the guests would see Crown Heights residents doing melachos, which might create the mistaken impression that they were being mechalel Shabbos, chas veshalom.

After his wife had bentched licht, R. Moshe Fein-

stein would travel by car from his house to Meisvita Tiferes Yerushalayim, a two-minute drive away. Once, someone mentioned to him that there were people who mistakenly thought he was being mechalel Shabbos. After explaining why no issur was involved, R. Moshe added that, nevertheless, he would avoid doing so in the future bli neder (*Shu"t Igros Moshe, Orach Chaim* 1:96).

I heard a similar story from my father AH. One Friday afternoon, R. Chaim Ozer Grodzinski, the famous rov of Vilna, sat on his porch smoking a pipe. As he was sitting there, he heard a passerby remark to his colleague: "Look at today's rabbonim—they even smoke on Shabbos!"

R. Chaim Ozer realized that they had already davened Maariv, leading them to think it was Shabbos for everyone in the community. This incident prompted him to resolve not to do melachos in public from when the earliest minyan in town davened Maariv.

Q: I DO NOT HAVE AN EARLY MINYAN FOR KABBALAS SHABBOS, BUT I AM INVITING GUESTS FOR THE MEAL AND WOULD LIKE TO START AT A NORMAL TIME. WHEN SHOULD I DAVEN MAARIV?

A: It is questionable whether you may daven Maariv and accept Shabbos early without a minyan.¹⁷ An additional question is whether your acceptance of Shabbos necessitates that your wife accept Shabbos as well (requiring her to

17 See *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 263:17.

A related question is whether accepting Shabbos early causes the non-shomer-Shabbos Jews in town to be mechalel Shabbos from that time. Rav Shlomo Zalman Auerbach notes that the minyan's kabbalas Shabbos only affects other shomer-Shabbos residents, and not those who are not accepting Shabbos at all (*Halichos Shlomo, Hilchos Tefillah* 14:3 fn. 7).

18 See *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 261:7.

19 See *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 90:10; *Piskei Teshuvos* 235:1 fn. 8.

stop doing melachos and to bentch light beforehand).²⁰

Therefore, the preferred option is to daven Maariv after the meal.²¹ (If doing so, you may daven Minchah after plag hamincha, even though you are making kiddush early.) No melachos may be done from kiddush and onward (e.g., bentching light), as making kiddush is considered accepting Shabbos.

If the meal will begin less than half an hour before tzeis hakochavim, appoint someone to remind you to daven Maariv later (otherwise, you may not wash for a meal before saying the evening Shema).²² Either way, it is recommended to make a break at tzeis hakochavim and encourage the guests to say the first parshah of Shema, thus giving them the opportunity to fulfill an additional mitzvah.



KIDDUSH

Q: SHABBOS STARTS AT 3:30, AND I INVITED GUESTS FOR A MEAL AT 7:30. MAY I MAKE KIDDUSH FOR MY FAMILY EARLIER IN THE EVENING, AND THEN MAKE KIDDUSH AGAIN FOR THE GUESTS?

A: Yes.

In order for the kiddush to be bema-kom seudah, those making or hearing kiddush should eat mezonos afterward; there is no need to wash for hamotzi at that time.²³

Similarly, if guests show up late, you may make kiddush for them (as many times as necessary).

²⁰ See *Piskei Teshuvos* 263:37.

²¹ See *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 267:3 that you may make kiddush and eat the Shabbos meal after plag hamincha even if you have not yet davened Maariv.

²² *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 267:4; *Mishnah Berurah* 235:18.

²³ *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 273:7.



WINE IN THE CHABAD HOUSE

WHAT IS THE proper approach to serving wine at the Shabbos table?

In the story related in the previous sidebar (p. 29), only one bottle of wine was brought to the Friediker Rebbe's table. The wine, which was completely covered, was kept beneath the table, and the Rebbe gave everyone l'chaim himself—not only the non-shomer-Shabbos Jew but also the venerable chassidim who were present. (Apparently the wine was not mevushal.)

The following letter, written by the Rebbe to Dr. David Kazhdan on 20 Cheshvan 5739,⁴ can give us further insight.

When inviting non-observant Jews, who had been brought up in non-observant homes, is it right to drink wine with them?

Answer: In view of the fact that non-observant Jews constitute a wide range from one end to the other, and, for understandable reasons, it is impossible to check everyone's Jewish credentials—why enter into a questionable situation, when there are many other drinks than wine that could be served in such company, with no "Shaalah" involved.

The Rebbe added the following paragraphs as an addendum to the letter:

Especially as the Shaalah (in most cases) involves also a question about the Kashrus of the wine.⁵

Where there is no question about the wine, and the occasion is inviting a guest (or guests) for Shabbos or Yom Tov, when Kiddush is involved, it is advisable that the host alone make Kiddush, and limit the partaking of wine to Kiddush only.

⁴ Printed in *Teshurah*, Gruzman-Landau, 10 Elul 5775, pp. 51–52; *Teshurah*, Shuchat, 4 Tammuz 5777—supplement to *Shelichus Kehilchasah*—p. 16.

⁵ Author's note: In other words, in addition to the issue of them touching the wine now, the kashrus of the wine to begin with may be dubious.



Q: THERE IS A CUSTOM TO REFRAIN FROM MAKING KIDDUSH ON FRIDAY NIGHT DURING THE SEVENTH HOUR AFTER CHATZOS.²⁴ SHOULD I KEEP THIS MINHAG IF IT WILL BE HARD FOR MY GUESTS OR CHILDREN TO WAIT?

A: If you have guests who are unfamiliar with this minhag and it will be difficult for them to wait, there is no need to delay kiddush. Similarly, if waiting will cause the children to be impatient or tired, and certainly if it will result in young children being unable to join the meal altogether, there is room to say that these factors override keeping this minhag.²⁵

Q: WHAT SHOULD I DO IF WOMEN JOIN IN SINGING SHALOM ALEICHEM, ETC.? IS IT BETTER TO AVOID STARTING SONGS IF I KNOW THEY WILL SING ALONG?

A: If men and/or children are also singing and they are louder than the women, this does not pose a problem. If no other men are singing, try to sing loudly so as to drown out their voices. In such cases, it might be prudent to avoid singing except what is necessary (e.g., Shalom Aleichem, bentching).

Q: HOW CAN THE ISSUE OF PAGUM BE AVOIDED WHEN MAKING KIDDUSH FOR GUESTS?

A: The halachah is that a kos shel berachah should not be pagum, namely, the wine in the cup should not have been tasted from beforehand.²⁶ This includes the cup of wine over which kiddush is made, as well as the wine given to family and guests as participation in kiddush.²⁷

This poses a problem when making kiddush for others. If the one making kiddush takes a sip and then distributes the wine to others, the wine they are drinking is pagum. How can this issue be avoided?

The recommended way to avoid this

²⁴ *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 271:3. For a lengthy discussion on this minhag, see "The Red Hour" at compassmagazine.org/redhour.

²⁵ See *Haoros Ubiurim*, issue 1117, pp. 68ff.

²⁶ *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 182:4.

²⁷ *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 271:18.



issue is to pour a bit of wine or grape juice into numerous cups for everyone present before making kiddush. This wine has the status of kos shel berachah, just like the leftover wine in the becher.²⁸ An added benefit is that many people are uncomfortable drinking from another person's cup.

Alternatively, immediately after making kiddush (before drinking), pour some of the wine into a cup. After drinking, add wine from the bottle to the second cup (if necessary) and distribute it to the guests (into their personal cups).²⁹

If you are only eating with your family, a third method can be used: After drinking from the wine, add some wine to the becher, thus "rectifying" it, and then give it out to others to drink.³⁰ (If the family members will be drinking from the becher itself, it is not necessary to add wine first.³¹ However, if you will be pouring from the becher into other cups, wine should first be added.)

When guests are present who want

²⁸ *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 190:5.

²⁹ See *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 190:5.

³⁰ See *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 190:5.

³¹ *Mishnah Berurah*, *Shaar Hatzitzun* 271:89. See also *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 472:24.

to have wine from your kiddush but may be particular about drinking wine from which you have sipped, it is best to employ one of the first two options.

Q: MAY I RECITE DEVARIM SHEBIKDU SHAH (E.G., KIDDUSH, BENTCHING) IF THERE ARE FEMALE GUESTS OPPOSITE ME WHO ARE NOT DRESSED MODESTLY?

A: In such a situation, try to turn to another direction when making kiddush or bentching.³²

Q: MAY THOSE LISTENING TO KIDDUSH MAKE THEIR OWN BERACHAH ON THE WINE?

A: Guests and family members do not need to make a berachah on their wine, as they are yotzei with your berachah.³³ However, they may make their own berachah if they wish, and indeed many people have the custom of doing so.³⁴

It should be noted that while it is

³² See *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 75:9.

³³ See *Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch* 190:8; *Igros Kodesh*, vol. 14, p. 29.

³⁴ See *Ketzos Hashulchan* 79:5 fn. 19.



preferable for each of the guests and family members to have a sip of wine for kiddush³⁵ (either from the wine in your becher or from their own cups—see previous page), if they did not do so they are still yotzei kiddush. (The only exception is at the Pesach seder, when each participant must drink arba kosos.)



MEAL AND BENTCHING

Q: DO ALL THE CHALLOS ON THE TABLE NEED TO COVERED DURING KIDDUSH, OR JUST THE TWO LOAVES THAT WILL BE USED FOR LECHEM MISHNEH?

A: It is preferable for all the challah on the table to be covered.³⁶ If eating mezonos after kiddush instead of challah, it is preferable for the mezonos to be covered

during kiddush.³⁷

Q: HOW IMPORTANT IS IT TO MAKE SURE THAT MY GUESTS WASH, MAKE A BERACHAH ON WHAT THEY EAT, AND BENTCH AFTERWARD?

A: The Shulchan Aruch rules that you should not give food to someone you know will not wash or make a berachah.³⁸ However, contemporary poskim explain that nonetheless, you may (and should) invite non-observant guests, even if they might not wash or make a berachah.³⁹ Of course, you should try your best to ensure they will wash, make all appropriate bera-chos, and bentch.

Mei'ikar hadin, guests are yotzei the berachah of hamotzi by listening to your berachah and answering amen.⁴⁰ However, since it is likely that a guest will mistakenly speak between your berachah and eating the challah, it is preferable for them to make their own berachah.⁴¹ If

they do not understand Hebrew, the bera-chah may be said in English (or whatever language they understand).⁴²

When bentching, it is recommended to say or sing at least the first berachah out loud. Those who know Hebrew should say the words along with you, while those who do not know Hebrew may say the blessing in English (or whatever language they understand). Alternatively (although less preferable), they may be yotzei by listening to your berachah and answering amen.⁴³

Q: SHOULD EACH PERSON EAT SOME OF THE CHALLAH USED FOR LECHEM MISHNEH (AS OPPOSED TO EATING SEPARATE SLICES/ROLLS)?

A: Lechat'chilah each person at the table should eat at least a small piece of challah from the two loaves used for lechem mishneh.⁴⁴ If you have a large number of guests and this is not feasible, place rolls and/or slices of challah on the tables in advance, for the guests to eat after you make lechem mishneh.

On a related note: The Rebbe quotes the Eshel Avraham who writes that a person is yotzei the obligation of lechem mishneh (with the lechem mishneh of the baal habayis) even if he has not yet washed his hands.⁴⁵

Q: WHAT IS THE DIN IF A NON-SHOMER-SHABBOS GUEST HELPS HIMSELF TO NON-MEVUSHAL WINE?

A: Non-mevushal wine may not be consumed if it was touched by a non-Jew or a Jew who is mechalel Shabbos in public. Lechat'chilah, such wine should not be seen by them either. Serving such wine might therefore lead to problems. One issue in question is whether today's non-shomer-Shabbos Jews (who have the status of tinokos shenishbu⁴⁶) have the status of Jews who are mechalel Shabbos

42 Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch 185:2.

43 Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch 185:1. See above, fn. 40.

44 See Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch 274:4.

45 Igros Kodesh, vol. 14, p. 30.

46 For a list of poskim who ruled this way, see Piskei Teshuvos 55:21 fn. 148. See also Likkutei Sichos, vol. 6, p. 273.

35 Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch 271:25.

36 See Piskei Teshuvos 271:18.

37 See Piskei Teshuvos 271:19.

38 Shulchan Aruch, Orach Chaim 169:1-2.

39 See Piskei Teshuvos 169:3 and fn. 13.

40 Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch 167:14; 213:1; 274:4.

In fact, they are yotzei even if they did not answer amen (Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch 213:4).

41 Igros Kodesh, vol. 14, pp. 29-30.



in public. Furthermore, the Jewish status of certain guests may sometimes be in doubt. Another issue is that the wine might be moved by non-Jewish cleaning help.

Bottles of non-mevushal wine must remain covered with an opaque bag or other covering. If you served such wine and the cup was moved by a guest, it might be forbidden to drink it, even if the guest did not drink from it.

Therefore, the best approach is to only serve mevushal wine, so as to avoid unnecessary shaylos. This includes the Pesach seder as well; if non-observant Jews will be present, there is no inyan to be machmir to use non-mevushal wine.

If you only have non-mevushal wine, the wine can be cooked before Shabbos until it bubbles, giving it the status of mevushal wine.

If a non-shomer-Shabbos Jew handles non-mevushal wine, a rov should be consulted.

(See sidebar on p. 31 for a letter of the Rebbe on this topic.)

Q: MAY WOMEN WASH MAYIM ACHARONIM?

A: Although women are generally accustomed not to wash mayim acharonim,⁴⁷ if they wish they may certainly do so.

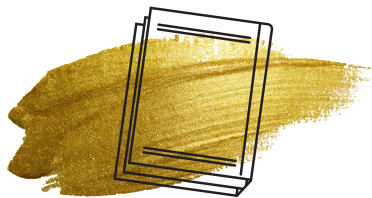
Q: MAY I MAKE A MEZUMAN IF I AM NOT SURE THAT ALL THE GUESTS ARE JEWISH?

A: A mezuman may only be made if at least three adult males who have participated in the meal are certainly Jewish.

If non-Jews are present when bentching, add the words “*bnai v’ris*” (after the words “*kein yevareich osanu*”).⁴⁸

Q: I INVITED A GROUP OF STUDENTS FOR THE SHABBOS MEAL. DO I NEED TO MAKE SURE THE BOYS AND GIRLS SIT SEPARATELY?

A: Yes, to whatever extent possible.



MELACHOS

Q: I ACCIDENTALLY LEFT FOOD INSIDE AN OVEN WITH A LIGHT THAT TURNS ON WHEN THE DOOR IS OPENED. WHAT SHOULD I DO?

A: A non-Jew may be asked to do an act that is not a melachah in itself but will inevitably result in a melachah (psik reishet).⁴⁹ Therefore, you may ask a non-Jew to open the door of the oven, even though this will cause the light to go on. Similarly, if you forgot to disconnect or turn off the light in the fridge, you may ask a non-Jew to open the door.

Q: IF GUESTS OFFER TO HELP IN THE KITCHEN, DO I NEED TO MAKE SURE THEY DO NOT DO ANY MELACHOS?

A: Yes. For example, if you see the guest using warm water or a scrubber to wash the dishes, show him how to wash dishes in a way that is permissible on Shabbos. If, after being told, the guest continues washing the dishes with a melachah, find a tactful way to stop him (e.g., tell him nicely that there is no need for him to bother, and that you will deal with the dishes yourself later). This is due to the mitzvah of tochachah, in which we are obligated to intervene when observing someone do a forbidden act.

Q: MAY I SEND AN EMAIL TO A NON-SHOMER-SHABBOS JEW LOCATED IN A DIFFERENT TIME ZONE, WHERE IT IS ALREADY SHABBOS?

A: No, as this may cause him to be mechalel Shabbos. Similarly, if a Jew gives you a phone call from a time zone where it is now Shabbos, you may not pick up the phone.

Discretion is necessary when sending

an email to a non-observant Jew right before Shabbos, as he might open the email on Shabbos.

Q: MAY I MAKE AN EVENT ON A HIGH FLOOR OF A BUILDING IF MOST PEOPLE WILL END UP USING THE ELEVATOR?

A: If the floor is low enough that using the steps is a practical option, you may make the event on that floor. However, if the floor is higher and using the steps is impractical, the event may not be made there.



EIRUV

Q: I AM RENTING A HOTEL FOR YOM KIPPUR SERVICES. WHAT MUST I DO TO ALLOW FOR CARRYING IN THE HALLWAYS AND OTHER PUBLIC AREAS OF THE HOTEL?

A: The best option is to “rent” the public areas for the duration of Yom Kippur by giving the hotel manager a few dollars.⁵⁰ If this was not done, you can rely on the fact that the hotel owns certain items in each room, and therefore there is no need to make an eiruvei chatzeiros.⁵¹

Of course, the above applies to Shabbos as well.

If you would like to be able to carry in the outside areas of the hotel, it may be necessary to erect poles with string so these areas will have the status of a reshut hayachid. Do not rely on taking care of this the day before Yom Kippur/Shabbos; visit the premises in advance, and call a rov with questions with ample time to spare.

In any case, it is highly recommended to pay an early visit to the hotel to take care of any relevant halachic issues, such as erecting an eiruv, kashrus, lights on

⁴⁷ See *Shu”t Shevet Halevi* 4:23.

⁴⁸ *Alter Rebbe’s Shulchan Aruch* 189:4.

⁴⁹ *Alter Rebbe’s Shulchan Aruch* 253:10.

⁵⁰ See *Alter Rebbe’s Shulchan Aruch* 382.

⁵¹ See *Igros Kodesh*, vol. 18, p. 556.

Shabbos, etc. All too often, I receive questions on these topics right before Shabbos, when it is far too late to deal with the matter properly.

Carrying in a hospital does not pose a problem, and no eiruvei chatzeiros is necessary. Conversely, where two or more Jewish families live in an apartment building, they must make an eiruvei chatzeiros to allow for carrying in the hallways.

Q: I LIVE IN A RURAL AREA, AND A LARGE FIELD SEPARATES MY HOUSE FROM THE HOME OF A COMMUNITY MEMBER. MAY I WALK TO HIS HOUSE ON SHABBOS?

A: On Shabbos or yom tov,⁵² it is forbidden to walk more than 2,000 amos (approximately 3,000 feet/914 meters) beyond the town's limits (i.e., where the town's houses end). If you desire to walk more than 2,000 amos, visit a spot within the town's limits before Shabbos and deposit the equivalent of two meals there (e.g., a box of matzah). Provided the food is still there when Shabbos sets in, you may walk an additional 2,000 amos from that point.⁵³

Since the laws of measuring the techum and making an eiruv techumin are very complex, a rov should be consulted whenever relevant. (If the field in question is fenced in, this fact should also be mentioned to the rov.)



SECURITY ON SHABBOS

Q: MAY A COMMUNITY MEMBER CARRY A GUN WITH HIM IN THE CHABAD HOUSE FOR SECURITY REASONS?

⁵² Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch 528:2.

⁵³ Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch 408:1; Alter Rebbe's Siddur, Seder Eiruvei Techumin.

A: When deemed a necessary precaution but not at pikuach-nefesh level, the best option is as follows:

The firearm should be placed in a suitable bag together with a non-muktzeh item.⁵⁴ This bag should be kept in a secure location on the Chabad House premises. Before davening, the one trained to use it should bring it discreetly to his place for the duration of the services. After davening, he should replace it safely.

Besides for the issue of muktzeh, there is another concern which applies during the week as well: The Shulchan Aruch states that one should not enter a shul with a large knife (or other weapon).⁵⁵ This objection would be withdrawn in a state of high-alert. However, it is still recommended to keep the weapon covered⁵⁶ (especially considering the fact that young children are present in shul).

In light of recent events, it is highly advisable to hire a non-Jewish security guard for Shabbos, yom tov, and whenever else large gatherings are expected at the Chabad House.

Q: MAY THE SECURITY CAMERAS IN THE CHABAD HOUSE FUNCTION ON SHABBOS?

A: Although there are those who are apprehensive about recording movements of passersby on Shabbos, there is ample basis to permit it. Even if there is a melachah involved, in this case there is no intent to video the regular congregants; rather, the motive is to gather information on suspicious people.⁵⁷

(Parenthetically, it should be emphasized that there is a difference between passing in front of a camera and passing in front of a sensor, which is more problematic. This is especially so when the sensor causes a light to be switched on, and even more so when you will make use of the light that has been created thereby—such as in a corridor or stairwell that was previously too dark to walk through.)

⁵⁴ See Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch 309:1.

⁵⁵ Orach Chaim 151:6.

⁵⁶ Shu"t Tzitz Eliezer 10:18; Shu"t Yechaveh Da'as 5:18.

⁵⁷ See Piskei Teshuvos 277:8 and fn. 84; Shemiras Shabbos Kehilchasah (third edition), ch. 123, fn. 175.

Recording images on a hard disk is not considered boneh nor makeh bepatish, because the device was "complete" without the information fed into it. As far as the melachah of koseiv is concerned, the Shevet Halevi⁵⁸ considers feeding data into a device as a form of writing, whereas R. Shlomo Zalman Auerbach⁵⁹ does not view the accumulation of pixels on a screen as writing. Plausibly, even the Shevet Halevi would not treat recording of images as he does the entering of data, where the latter is the conventional form of registering text.⁶⁰ There would therefore be no issue in allowing the cameras to function on Shabbos.

Although the cameras may function on Shabbos, Shabbos recordings may not be publicized (except for security purposes).

Q: THE FRONT DOOR OF MY CHABAD HOUSE IS EQUIPPED WITH A MAGNETIC LOCK, AND IS MANNED ON SHABBOS BY A NON-JEW. IS IT PROBLEMATIC FOR THE NON-JEW TO OPEN THE DOOR BY PRESSING AN ELECTRIC BUTTON?

A: Theoretically, the non-Jew can open the door manually; the reason he is pressing a button instead is merely to save his energy. His action is therefore not viewed as a service done for you via a melachah, and it is permitted at least beshaas hadechak.⁶¹ Another factor is that the non-Jew is not doing this act on your behalf but as part of his job.⁶²

Similarly, if a hotel guest is locked out of his room on Shabbos, he may ask a non-Jewish attendant to open the magnetic door of the room. 🚪

⁵⁸ 6:37 and 10:60.

⁵⁹ Cited in Nishmas Avraham (second edition), Orach Chaim, 340:6:11.

⁶⁰ Unlike Piskei Teshuvos 277 fn. 79, who equates images with data.

⁶¹ Shemiras Shabbos Kehilchasah (third edition), 30:65. See also Nesivim Bisdei Hashlichus, vol. 3, ch. 4, fn. 16.

⁶² See Alter Rebbe's Shulchan Aruch 307:7.